

Ἡράκλειτος ὁ Ἐφέσιος

Flux and Fire in Heraclitus of Ephesus

eul_aid: bky

Period: Ἀρχαϊκή [Archaic](#)
Dialect: Μικτὰι διάλεκτοι [Mixed Dialects \(frg\)](#)
Domain: Φιλοσοφία [Philosophy](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)
Affiliation: [Presocratic](#)

Heraclitus of Ephesus was a Greek philosopher active around 500 BCE. He was born into an aristocratic family in the Ionian city of Ephesus. According to later stories, he was known for a reclusive and critical temperament, which earned him ancient nicknames like "the Obscure" and "the Weeping Philosopher."

He is traditionally credited with a single major prose work, often referred to by later authors as **On Nature**, though its original title is unknown. This book does not survive intact. Instead, about 130 short, often paradoxical statements from it are preserved as fragments in the writings of later philosophers, historians, and Christian authors.

Heraclitus is a foundational figure in early Greek philosophy. His significance lies in a system built on the idea of constant change, famously expressed in the concept that "everything flows" and the analogy that one cannot step into the same river twice. He proposed fire as a primary cosmic principle and introduced the idea of the Logos, a rational order or law governing the universe's changes. His work emphasized the unity of opposites and a hidden harmony within apparent conflict.

His cryptic style and ideas deeply influenced later thinkers, including Plato, the Stoics, and many philosophers into the modern era.

Works (2)

- Ἀποσπάσματα · [On the Nature of the Universe](#) · 146 passages
- Μαρτυρίαι · [Testimonies](#) · 29 passages

Other Presocratic Authors

- Ἀλκμαίων ὁ Κροτωνιάτης · [Alcmaeon of Croton](#) · 2 works
- Ἀναξαγόρας ὁ Κλαζομένιος · [Anaxagoras of Clazomenae](#) · 2 works
- Ἀναξίμανδρος ὁ Μιλήσιος · [Anaximander of Miletus](#) · 2 works
- Ἀναξίμενης ὁ Μιλήσιος · [Anaximenes of Miletus](#) · 2 works
- Ἀναξιμένους τοῦ Μιλησίου Ἐπιστολαί (Ψευδο-Ἀναξίμενης) · [Anaximenes-pseudo Miletus Letters](#) · 1 work
- Ἀρχέλαος ὁ Μιλήσιος ὁ Ἀθηναῖος · [Archelaus of Miletus](#) · 2 works
- Κλεόβουλος ὁ Λίνδιος · [Cleobulus of Lindos I](#) · 1 work
- Δημόκριτος ὁ Ἀβδηρίτης · [Democritus of Abdera](#) · 2 works

- Διογένης ὁ Ἀπολλωνιάτης · Diogenes of Apollonia · 2 works
- Ἐμπεδοκλῆς ὁ Ἀκραγαντίνος · Empedocles of Acragas · 3 works
- Ἡράκλειτος ὁ Ἐφέσιος · Heraclitus of Ephesus II · 1 work
- Ἑρμόδωρος ὁ Ἐφέσιος · Hermodorus of Ephesus · 2 works